FLORINDOLAB

Capture by FlorindoLAB — User guide

Version 1.2 Windows 10 / 11

CONTENTS

1 Overview
2 Installation and first launch
3 The Capture screen
4 Projects
5 The editor
6 Export
7 Files and folders
8 Keyboard shortcuts
9 FAQ and troubleshooting
10 Known limitations
11 Licenses and credits

1 Overview

Capture by FlorindoLAB is a free Windows app that records a single window as video, so you can make clean software demos that are ready to publish.

- **Cut-out window with transparency**: only the window you pick is captured, placed on a canvas with a margin, rounded corners and a drop shadow.
- **Redrawn cursor**: the cursor is recorded separately, then redrawn crisply, with an adjustable halo and click ripples.
- **Automatic zooms** on your clicks, which you can then move, stretch or delete.
- **Multitrack audio**: system sound and microphone on separate tracks, each with its own volume curve.
- **Mini editor**: split, trim, speed up, reorder, transitions, notes (text, arrow, box, spotlight, blur).
- **Ready-made exports**: DaVinci Resolve (transparent MOV), YouTube, Instagram / Shorts, square, transparent web video, PNG sequence... several formats in one click.

The app window has three tabs:

Capture | Projects | Editor

In the top-right corner:

- **FR | EN**: switches the interface language. The change is instant and remembered.
- **? Help**: opens this guide inside the app, in the current language.
- **About**: app version, component licenses and a link to florindolab.com.

2 Installation and first launch

2.1 Portable version

There's nothing to install: unzip the folder wherever you like (any drive, your work folder, even a USB stick) and run `Capture by FlorindoLAB.exe`.

The folder contains:

- `Capture by FlorindoLAB.exe`: the app itself;
- `ffmpeg.exe` and `ffprobe.exe`: required for recording, preview and export;
- the user guides (English and French);

- the licenses file.

> **WARNING**
>
> Always keep `ffmpeg.exe` and `ffprobe.exe` **next to the exe**. If you move the app, move the whole folder.

2.2 System requirements

- **Windows 11** (recommended) or an up-to-date 64-bit **Windows 10**.
- **WebView2** (the engine that displays the interface): already included in Windows 11. On Windows 10, it comes with Microsoft Edge. If it's missing, download the "WebView2 Runtime" from Microsoft's website.

2.3 First launch: SmartScreen

The app isn't digitally signed yet. The first time you run it, Windows may show "**Windows protected your PC**". If so:

1. click **More info**;
2. then **Run anyway**.

Windows normally won't ask again for this file.

---

3 The Capture screen

This is the home screen: pick the window, framing, style and audio, then start recording. Your settings are remembered between sessions.

3.1 Window or full screen

At the top left, choose what to record: ▭ **Window** (a single cut-out window) or 🖵 **Full screen**.

Full screen

- The list shows each screen, with a small map of your screen layout (the chosen screen is in gold) and its resolution. The primary screen is marked.
- With several screens, **All screens** records them together as one large desktop. If the screens differ in size or aren't aligned, the empty areas stay transparent.
- The Capture by FlorindoLAB window is **hidden from the video** during a screen recording (Windows 10 version 2004 or later).

- “Window size” and “Include menus and pop-ups” don't apply to full screen: everything on screen is recorded.
- Canvas, style (margin, rounded corners, shadow), cursor, zooms and audio work just like for a window. For a plain screen, set the margin to 0 and untick the shadow.
- All screens together make a very large image: pick a canvas (1440p or 4K) and 30 fps to keep recording smooth.

Window

Pick the window from the list on the left. The search field filters the list, and the ⟳ button refreshes it (for instance after opening another program). The selected window is shown in the bottom bar, next to the **Record** button.

3.2 Framing

- **Window size**: resizes the captured window before recording (1280 × 720, 1600 × 900, 1920 × 1080, 2240 × 1260, 1080 × 1080), or leave it unchanged.
- **Canvas**: size of the final picture around the window (1080p, 1440p, 4K, square, Insta 1080 × 1350, vertical 1080 × 1920), or none to keep the window's own size.
- **Frame rate**: 30 or 60 frames per second.

> **TIP**
>
> Capture larger than your final video so zooms stay sharp. For example: a 1600 × 900 window on a 1440p canvas, for a 1080p export.

3.3 Window style

- **Margin**: space between the window and the edge of the canvas (0 to 160 px).
- **Rounded corners**: corner radius of the window (0 to 32 px).
- **Drop shadow**: adds a shadow under the window.
- **Include menus and pop-ups**: also captures drop-down menus, context menus and small windows that open on top (see Troubleshooting).

3.4 Audio

Tick **system sound** and/or **Microphone**, then pick the device from the list below each one. Each source is recorded on its own track, which you can adjust separately in the editor.

3.5 Options

- **Automatic zooms on clicks**: creates zooms around your clicks. You can edit or recalculate them in the editor.
- **Zoom level**: magnification of those zooms (×1.2 to ×3).
- **Countdown**: none, 3 s or 5 s before recording starts.
- **Minimize this window while recording**: the app gets out of the way during the recording.

3.6 Captures folder

At the bottom of the Capture screen:

- 📁 **Choose...** opens the Windows folder picker;
- **Default** goes back to `Videos\Capture by FlorindoLAB`;
- **Open** shows the folder in File Explorer.

Your choice is remembered, and the folder is created if it doesn't exist.

3.7 Still image

The ◫ **Still image** button takes a PNG with transparency: cut-out window, shadow, margins and canvas, **without the cursor**. It uses the same settings as the video.

The countdown gives you time to open a menu or hover over a button before the shot. The image is saved in the captures folder; the **Show** button in the notification opens it in File Explorer.

3.8 Record and stop

1. Click **Record**.
2. After the countdown, recording starts (and the app minimizes if that option is ticked). The Capture by FlorindoLAB window never appears in the video.
3. Do your demo.
4. To stop: Ctrl + Shift + F9, or bring the app back and click ■ **Stop**.

The editor then opens automatically on your capture.

> **TIP**
> Ctrl + Shift + F9 works even while the app is minimized. It's the cleanest way to stop, with no stray click at the end of your video.

4 Projects

The **Projects** tab lists the captures in your captures folder. Each card shows a preview (it plays when you hover over it), the title, duration, size, date, and an “exported” tag if the capture has already been exported.

- **Click a card**: opens the capture in the editor.
- **📁 Change folder…**: picks a different captures folder (the same setting as at the bottom of the Capture screen).
- **Refresh**: rereads the folder.
- **Open folder**: shows it in File Explorer.

All editor settings are saved automatically in the project, so you can close the app and pick up where you left off. Captures made with earlier versions still open.

5 The editor

The editor is made of the **preview** (top), the **playback and tools bar**, the **timeline** (bottom) and a side panel with six tabs:

Edit | Zooms | Notes | Cursor | Audio | Export

5.1 Preview and playback

- The preview shows zooms, cursor and notes **live**.
- Space or ▶: play / pause.
- ← / →: step one frame. With Shift: one second.
- The **Zooms** checkbox in the bar turns zooms on or off.
- **Preview sound**: each track plays with its volume and curve, following your edit. The 🔈 button or the M key mutes the preview (this doesn't affect the export).

> **TIP**
> The preview shows a solid background instead of transparency. That's expected: MOV, WebM and PNG exports keep it.

5.2 The timeline: tracks, size and zoom

From top to bottom, the timeline contains:

- the **Edit** track: each blue block is a clip you keep; a diamond marks each join between clips;
- the **purple** notes track;
- the **clicks**: copper marks for left clicks, **blue** marks for right clicks;
- the **zooms**: gold blocks;
- the **audio tracks**: waveforms of the system sound and the microphone.

The timeline shows the edited video: when you delete a clip, the remaining blocks close the gap, and zooms, notes, clicks and audio follow.

Timeline size

Drag the small bar above the timeline upwards: the timeline grows and the preview shrinks accordingly. The audio tracks use the extra room. Double-click the bar to return to normal size. The height you pick is remembered.

Zooming the timeline

- Ctrl + mouse wheel (around the pointer), or the **−** / **+** / **Fit** buttons on the right of the bar.
- Once zoomed in, the wheel scrolls the timeline left and right (Shift + wheel if the timeline also scrolls vertically).
- During playback, the view follows the playhead.

5.3 Editing

Editing happens in the **Edit** track (top of the timeline) and in the **Edit** tab, which also shows the length of the capture and of the edited video.

A single click on a clip selects it and always moves the playhead.

Split

S or **✂ Split here**: splits the clip at the playhead.

Trim

- Drag the left or right edge of a clip to shorten its start or end.
- I / O: sets the clip's start / end at the playhead.
- For exact values, the **Edit** tab has start and end fields (in seconds, measured in the capture).
- To get a trimmed part back, drag the clip's edge the other way, or press Ctrl + Z.

Speed

In the **Edit** tab, set the selected clip's speed: ×0.5, ×1, ×1.5, ×2, ×4 or ×8.

> **WARNING**
>
> At any speed other than ×1, the clip's sound is muted.

Delete

Delete or the delete-clip button: removes the selected clip; the remaining blocks close the gap. You can't delete the last remaining clip.

Reorder

- Drag a clip to its new position: a gold line shows where it will land.
- Or use Alt + ← / →, or the ◀ Earlier / Later ▶ buttons in the Edit tab.
- Restore order puts the clips back in capture order **without undoing your cuts**.
- Reset all goes back to the full capture, as a single clip.

Zooms, notes and the cursor stay locked to the capture: splitting or moving a clip takes them along. A zoom or note that straddles two separated clips appears in several pieces (dotted edge).

Transitions

Click the **diamond** on a join between two clips, then pick one in the Edit tab:

- **Hard cut**;
- **Cross-fade**: the end of the previous clip blends into the next one;
- **Dip to background**: fade out, then fade back in.

Set the **duration** with the slider; the apply-to-all button copies the same setting to every join. Pressing Delete on a selected join turns it back into a hard cut. A clip's transition moves with it when you reorder.

Fade-in and fade-out

In the same tab, the **fade-in** and **fade-out** sliders (0 to 3 s) add a fade at the start and end of the video.

Dip-to-background transitions, the fade-in and the fade-out go through transparency in the MOV, and through the background colour in the MP4.

5.4 Zooms

In the timeline, the gold blocks are zooms.

- Drag them to move them, or drag their edges to change their duration.
- + Zoom here adds one at the playhead.

- Delete removes the selected zoom.

Zooms tab:

- **Selected zoom**: start, end and level (×1.1 to ×4), plus a button to delete it;
- **Camera**: inertia (how quickly the camera follows the cursor) and how long zooms take to ease in and out;
- **Automatic recalculation**: level, lead time before the click, hold time after, grouping of nearby clicks, then the recalculate button.

> **WARNING**
>
> Recalculating replaces your existing zooms with new ones. If you don't like the result, press Ctrl + Z.

5.5 Notes

The tools sit above the timeline:

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
T Text	a caption, with or without a background
↗ Arrow	an arrow pointing at something
▭ Box	a rectangle around an area
◎ Spotlight	darkens everything except the chosen area
▩ Blur	blurs an area to hide information

Creating a note

Pick a tool, then drag on the preview (or click, for text). The note starts at the playhead and lasts 3 s. Esc cancels the current tool.

Editing a note

- Click a note (in the preview or the timeline) to select it. Dragging inside it moves it.
- The **white handles** resize it: corners and side midpoints for a box, spotlight or blur; ends for an arrow; corner for text size. The mouse pointer changes when you hover a handle.
- In the timeline, the purple track sets each note's start and end.
- Delete removes the selected note.

Notes tab

It adjusts the selected note: text, size, colours, bold, background and its opacity, thickness, rounded corners, blur strength, darkening, fade, start and end. For exact values: width / height (box, spotlight, blur) and length (arrow).

Fixed on screen keeps a text still during zooms. Otherwise, notes are pinned to the content and follow the camera.

> **TIP**
> When paused, the preview shows notes at full opacity; their fades only show during playback.

5.6 Cursor

Cursor tab:

- **show the cursor**, **size**, movement **smoothing**, **hide outside the window**;
- **Halo** around the cursor: colour, radius, opacity;
- **Click ripples**: one colour for left clicks (copper by default) and one for right clicks (blue by default).

5.7 Audio

The audio tracks sit under the timeline (one for system sound, one for the microphone). Each has a **volume curve**:

- **Click** a track: adds a volume point at the height you clicked. The first point also adds a 100 % starting point just before it.
- **Drag**: moves the point, showing its value in %.
- **Double-click**: removes the point.
- **M** button on the left of the track: mutes that track.

The Audio tab also has an overall volume for each track and a button to clear the curve.

The export applies exactly the same settings: volume, curve, transitions, plus short fades at every join to avoid clicks. In the MOV, each track stays separate (track 1 = system sound, track 2 = microphone); in the MP4, they're mixed together.

5.8 Undo and redo

- Ctrl + Z: undo.

- Ctrl + Y (or Ctrl + Shift + Z): redo.
- Or the ↶ ↷ buttons in the playback bar.

This covers cuts, clip order and speed, transitions and fades, zooms, notes and audio. The history is cleared when you reopen a project.

---

6 Export

Everything happens in the editor's **Export** tab.

6.1 Destination

- **Export folder**: 📁 **Choose...**, **Default** (= the captures folder), **Open**. The folder you pick is reused for later captures.
- **File name**: the capture's name by default. An example of the final name is shown underneath.

6.2 Presets

Built-in presets:

PRESET	WHAT YOU GET
Resolve — transparent MOV	ProRes 4444 MOV with transparency, capture size
YouTube 1080p	MP4, 1920 × 1080
YouTube 4K	MP4, 3840 × 2160
Instagram / Shorts vertical	MP4, 1080 × 1920
Instagram 4:5	MP4, 1080 × 1350
Square 1080	MP4, 1080 × 1080
Transparent web (WebM)	VP9 WebM with transparency, 1920 × 1080
Transparent PNG sequence	one PNG per frame, capture size
Animated GIF (web)	GIF without sound, 640 px wide by default, on the background colour

- **Click a name**: applies its settings (you can tweak them afterwards).

- **Tick boxes + Export checked presets**: everything is exported in one go, and each file is named after its preset (`title.youtube-1080p.mp4`, `title.instagram-vertical.mp4`…).

Your presets

Set the size, formats and background, type a name in the new-preset field, then click **Save**. Your presets are available in every project; **×** deletes one.

6.3 Settings

- **Output size**: same as the capture, 1080p, 1440p, 4K, square, Insta 1080 × 1350 or vertical. In vertical or square, the camera follows the cursor.
- **Formats**: tick one or more formats (see below).
- **Background (MP4 and GIF)**: the colour that replaces transparency in the MP4 and the GIF.

Export range

Tick **Export only a part** to export just a section of the edited video, without touching the edit. Set the **Start** and **End** (in seconds of the edited video), or move the playhead and click **⇤ Start here** / **End here ⇥**. The range shows in gold on the timeline and the rest is dimmed. It applies to every ticked format and is saved with the project.

Then click **Export with these settings**. A progress bar tracks the export, and the files created are listed underneath.

Notes stay sharp and correctly placed in every format; a “Fixed on screen” text is repositioned proportionally.

6.4 Formats

FORMAT	TRANSPARENCY	USE
MOV ProRes 4444	yes	editing in DaVinci Resolve or another editor; separate audio tracks
MP4 H.264	no (solid background)	social media, sharing; encoded with the H.264 encoder built into Windows (Media Foundation); mixed audio
WebM VP9	yes	web pages
PNG sequence	yes	individual frames, for compositing
Animated GIF	no (solid background)	web, messaging apps, documentation; no sound, loops

Animated GIF

When **Animated GIF** is ticked, two settings appear: the **GIF width** (480, 640, 800 or 1080 px; never wider than the video) and the **frames per second** (10 to 20). The estimated file size is shown just below.

- The GIF has **no sound** and **loops** forever.
- It sits on the background colour: GIF transparency is all-or-nothing, so the shadow and rounded corners would look jagged. For a transparent animation on the web, use WebM.
- Keep it **short**: beyond 15 s the file quickly gets heavy. Use **Export only a part** to keep just the essentials.

> **TIP**
> Only ticked formats are created: if you don't need the MOV, untick it to save time and disk space.

6.5 After export

- **Keep the sources** (default): the capture stays editable.
- **Keep only the exported files**: after a successful export, the capture's separate layers go to the **Recycle Bin** (you can still restore them), and the capture disappears from the **Projects** tab.

> **WARNING**
>
> With “Keep only the exported files”, you can no longer change the edit unless you restore the sources from the Recycle Bin.

---

7 Files and folders

By default, everything goes into `Videos\Capture by FlorindoLAB`:

```
Captures folder\
├─ My_video_20261104_101010.mp4          ← edited files (exports), easy to spot
├─ My_video_20261104_101010.youtube-1080p.mp4
├─ Window_20261104_102000.png            ← still images
└─ sources\
   └─ My_video_20261104_101010\          ← one capture = one folder of layers
      ├─ ….fenetre.mov        window only, no cursor
      ├─ ….curseur.csv        cursor positions and clicks
      ├─ ….systeme.wav / ….micro.wav     audio tracks
      ├─ ….apercu.mp4 / ….apercu.*.ogg   lightweight previews for the editor
      └─ ….projet.json        editor settings
```

The layer file suffixes keep their original (French) names: `fenetre` = window, `curseur` = cursor, `systeme` = system sound, `apercu` = preview, `projet` = project.

- Exports can go to another folder (**Export** tab → Destination).
- Editor settings are saved automatically in `….projet.json`.
- Captures made with earlier versions (“flat” files) still open.

> **WARNING**
>
> Don't rename or split up the files in a `sources\…` folder: the editor needs every layer to reopen and re-export the capture.

8 Keyboard shortcuts

KEYS	ACTION
Capture	
Ctrl + Shift + F9	Stop recording (works while the app is minimized)
Editor — playback	
Space	Play / pause
← / →	Previous / next frame
Shift + ← / →	One second back / forward
M	Mute / unmute the preview
Editor — editing	
S	Split the clip at the playhead
I / O	Set the clip's start / end at the playhead
Alt + ← / →	Move the selected clip earlier / later
Delete	Delete the selection (note, clip or zoom); on a join: hard cut
Esc	Cancel the current note tool
Ctrl + Z	Undo
Ctrl + Y or Ctrl + Shift + Z	Redo
Editor — timeline (mouse)	
Ctrl + wheel	Zoom the timeline in / out
Wheel	Scroll the zoomed timeline
Shift + wheel	Scroll sideways when the timeline also scrolls vertically
Double-click the bar	Reset the timeline to normal size

Editor shortcuts are ignored while you're typing in a text field.

---

9 FAQ and troubleshooting

9.1 “FFmpeg not found”

A “FFmpeg not found” badge appears at the top of the window: `ffmpeg.exe` and `ffprobe.exe` aren't next to `Capture by FlorindoLAB.exe`. Put them back in the same folder as the exe (they ship with the app), then restart it.

9.2 “Windows protected your PC”

That's SmartScreen: the app isn't signed yet. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway** (see 2.3).

9.3 Menus or context menus don't show up in the video

- Check that **Include menus and pop-ups** is ticked on the Capture screen.
- This feature depends on your version of Windows. If it isn't available, the app warns you and records without menus. An up-to-date, recent Windows 11 gives the best results.
- Some programs draw their menus in a way Windows doesn't link to the window: they may be missing even with the option ticked. Do a short test before a long demo.

9.4 The preview doesn't show transparency

That's normal: the editor preview uses a solid background. ProRes 4444 MOV, VP9 WebM and PNG sequence exports keep transparency. MP4 doesn't support it and uses the “MP4 background” colour instead.

9.5 Export is slow after I reordered clips

That's expected. When clips are no longer in capture order, the export runs in two passes: each clip is first rendered to a lossless intermediate file, then everything is assembled in edit order with the transitions. It takes roughly twice as long. **Restore order** brings you back to a single-pass export.

9.6 I can't see the cross-fade in the preview

Cross-fades and note fades only show during playback. When paused, the preview shows the clip's frame.

9.7 A clip has no sound

Its speed isn't ×1: at any other speed, the clip's sound is muted. Also check the track's **M** button, its volume curve and the preview mute (**M**).

---

10 Known limitations

- Windows only.
- The preview doesn't show transparency: the background is solid (MOV, WebM and PNG exports keep it).
- The redrawn cursor is always an arrow.
- There's no shortcut yet to **start** a capture without going through the app (only to stop it).
- In the preview, cross-fades only show during playback.
- At any speed other than ×1, the clip's sound is muted.
- Capturing menus and pop-ups depends on your Windows version and on the program being captured.
- The app isn't signed yet: SmartScreen may flag it on first launch.

---

11 Licenses and credits

Capture by FlorindoLAB is free software made by **FlorindoLAB** — florindolab.com.

- It uses **FFmpeg** (`ffmpeg.exe`, `ffprobe.exe`), distributed under the **LGPL**.
- The licenses of all components are listed in the **licenses file** shipped in the app folder, and in the **About** window (top-right corner of the app).

Capture by FlorindoLAB — User guide, version 1.2 · florindolab.com ·